Spring MVC Security - Dev Testing with Private Incognito Windows

During development and testing phases, you may encounter an issue where the user remains logged in even after changes are made to the code. Let's explore this problem in detail.

If you've logged into the application, made some adjustments to your code, and then retested the application, you might notice that the user is still logged in. There's no need to see the login form, which is not ideal in a development environment.

To illustrate this, let's add some text like "Yoohoo" to our code and then save it. Now, if we return to the homepage and reload it, we'll see the new entry, "Yoohoo." However, the user was not prompted to log in again—they're already logged in.

Why does this happen? The user login is based on a web browser session. So, as long as that browser is open, or the process is running, they'll remain logged in.

It's important to note that this issue occurs only during development and testing. Once your project is deployed to production servers, this becomes a non-issue.

Let's keep exploring this. If you copy the URL and open it in a new browser window, the user will still be logged in. This behavior is tied to the web browser session and the specific process that initiated it.

A possible solution is to start a new web browser altogether. This action forces a new session, and the user must log in again. However, if you make further code changes and then reload the browser, you'll see the same problem. For example, add "Silly Goose" to the code, save, and reload. You'll see the new entry, but the user is still logged in.

To truly reset the session, you need to quit the browser entirely, not just close a window. Upon restarting the browser and pasting the URL, you'll be forced to log in again. This ensures a new session is created.

If quitting the browser altogether seems cumbersome, you can open a new private window or an incognito window in Chrome. In this mode, you will always see the login page, making it a convenient solution during testing.

Let's recap the methods to resolve this development issue:

1. **Start a new web browser from scratch.**
2. **Quit the browser entirely and restart it.**
3. **Open a new private window or incognito window.**

Simply creating a new window or tab is not enough; one of the above steps must be employed to achieve the desired outcome.